DEFENCE

INDIA'S NEW TANK KILLER

India has signed a Letter of Offer and Acceptance with the US on August 28 for the purchase of Javelin anti-tank missile systems under the government's emergency procurement programme. The acquisition adds to the army's anti-armour arsenal. The state-of-the-art Anti-Tank Guided Missile (ATGM) might also be co-produced in India in the future, for which an MoU was signed between Tata Advanced Systems Limited and the Javelin Joint Venture, comprising US defence firms Raytheon and Lockheed Martin, on August 30. It explores an Indian facility for final assembly, along with production of components

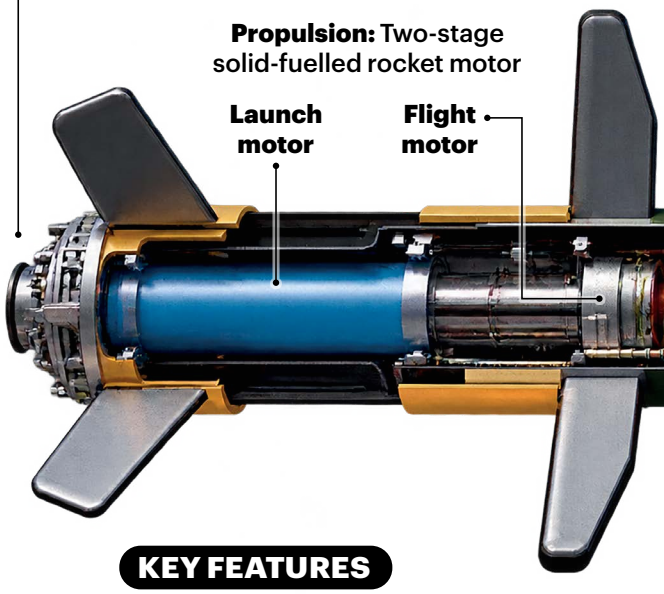
Text by **PRADIP R. SAGAR**
Graphic by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**

₹292 CRORE

Approximate cost of the deal for around 60 missile rounds and lightweight command launch units

WHAT IS THE JAVELIN?

The FGM-148 Javelin anti-tank guided missile is a US-made shoulder-fired, man-portable third-generation ATGM system. It's a weapon designed to neutralise heavily armoured main battle tanks, armoured vehicles, fortified bunkers and low-flying helicopters. Javelins would complement India's existing ATGMs—a shift from operator-guided missiles to sensor-guided fire-and-forget systems



KEY FEATURES

FIRE-AND-FORGET
The operator uses the Command Launch Unit (CLU) to detect and lock onto the target. Unlike older wire-guided systems, once the missile is launched, its infrared guidance system guides it towards the target, allowing the operator to relocate or reposition

EFFECTIVE RANGE
Approximately 65 metres to 4 km in most operating conditions

MAN-PORTABLE
The Javelin can be carried/ launched by a single soldier

